

BUDGET COMMITTEE MEETING – Thursday May 21, 2026

9:00 a.m. – Anne Basker Auditorium

600 N.W. Sixth Street, Grants Pass, OR 97526

Budget Committee: Ron Smith, Colene Martin, and Gary Richardson, Marc Kirby, Chris Collins (Absent) and Dorothy Yetter; Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Budget Officer: Arthur O'Hare

1) Open Meeting – Gary Richardson, Budget Committee Chair

Commissioner Richardson opened the meeting at 9:01 a.m.

2) Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest

Before departmental presentations began, Chair Richardson discussed current County staffing levels and reviewed information comparing active County staffing levels to proposed budgeted full-time equivalent positions (FTEs). Richardson explained that County staffing levels during recent months had ranged between approximately 392 and 400 filled positions, while the proposed Fiscal Year 2026–2027 budget reflected approximately 425 budgeted FTE positions. Richardson stated that the Board had previously requested that departments prepare budget presentations based primarily on currently filled positions rather than maintaining vacant positions within proposed departmental budgets unless specifically justified through operational requests.

Richardson distributed comparative staffing information to Budget Committee members and stated that several departments included budgeted positions exceeding currently filled staffing levels. Richardson explained that the information was intended to provide additional context for departmental budget discussions and future staffing considerations during the budget process.

3) Department Presentations:

a. Facilities – Ryan Johnson

Ryan Johnson, Facilities Director, presented the proposed Facilities Department budget and provided an overview of departmental operations and responsibilities. The department is responsible for maintenance and repair of County buildings and properties, communication and security systems, custodial support, and capital improvement projects. Discussions occurred regarding staffing levels, facility maintenance needs, reserve funding, long-term infrastructure planning, and future capital improvement priorities.

b. Transit – Scott Chancey-Exhibit 1 PowerPoint Presentation

Scott Chancey presented the proposed Transit Department budget and provided an overview of departmental operations, ridership trends, grant funding, and transportation services provided throughout Josephine County. Exhibit 1 – Transit PowerPoint Presentation. Discussions occurred regarding federal and state transportation funding, vehicle replacement planning, operational costs, and future sustainability considerations for transit services within Josephine County

c. Recreation – Tamra Martin-Exhibit 2 PowerPoint Presentation

Tamra Martin presented the proposed Recreation Department budget and reviewed operations associated with the Fairgrounds and Recreation Department facilities. Martin discussed Fairgrounds maintenance projects, event coordination, operational funding, and long-term facility planning considerations. Exhibit 2 – Recreation PowerPoint Presentation. Discussion occurred regarding Fairgrounds capital projects, event revenue, deferred maintenance, and preservation of Fairgrounds facilities and infrastructure

d. Airports – Michael Crissafulli

Michael Crissafulli presented the proposed Airports Department budget and discussed airport operations, lease revenue, infrastructure maintenance, and future airport development considerations. Discussion included airport maintenance responsibilities, lease management, operational funding, and ongoing planning

associated with airport facilities and operations. Budget Committee members discussed airport operational structure, infrastructure planning, and future budget considerations associated with airport operations and maintenance responsibilities

4) Budget Officer answers questions/provides requested information

Arthur O'Hare responded to Budget Committee questions and provided additional clarification regarding budget structure, departmental funding, staffing calculations, and reserve considerations discussed during departmental presentations.

5) Public Comment *(limit of three minutes each)*

No public testimony was provided.

6) Confirm next scheduled meeting.

May 27, 2026 at 1:00 p.m.

The meeting adjourned at 12:31 p.m.

Exhibit 1 – Transit - Scott Chancey-Exhibit 1 PowerPoint Presentation

Exhibit 2 – Recreation – Tamra Martin-Exhibit 2 PowerPoint Presentation

Transit Department

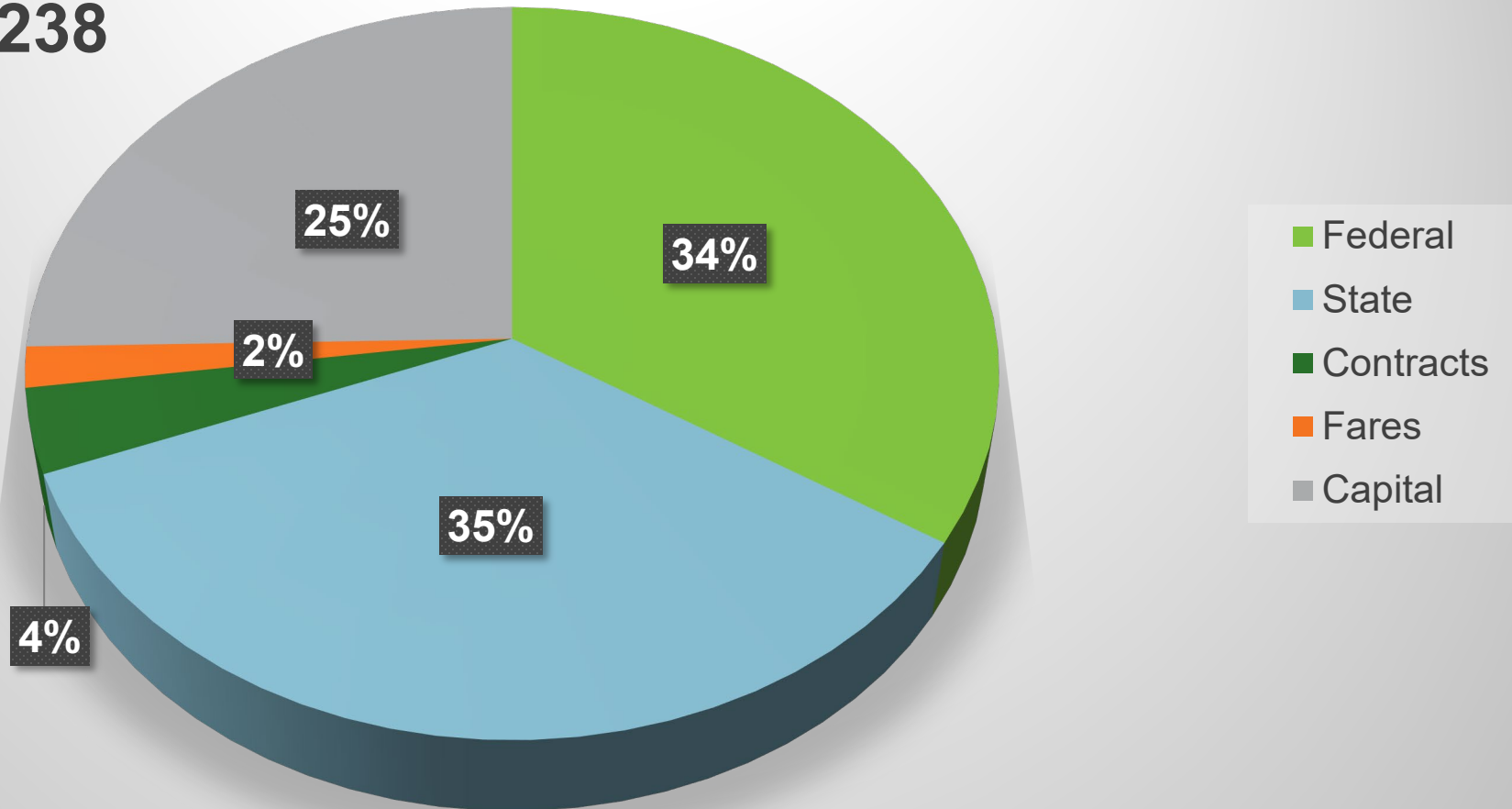
FY 2026-2027



Program Overview – Revenue

*no Josephine County General Fund dollars

Transit Revenue
\$5,623,238



FEDERAL

Operating funding requires between a 10.27% and 50% match rate

STATE

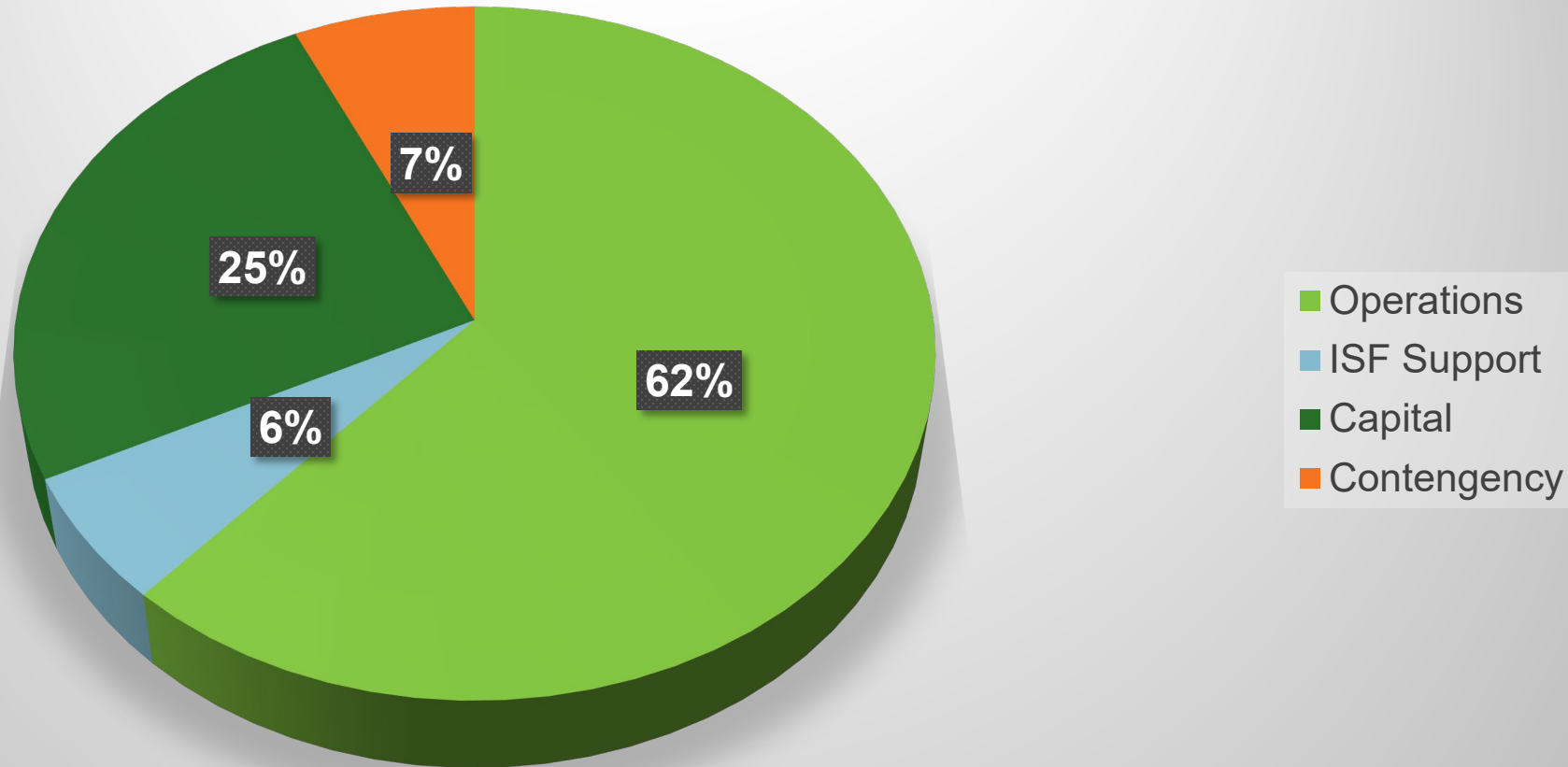
There is a zero match rate for state funds and they can be used for match for other grants

CAPITAL

Requires a 10.27% local match, derived from non-federal or program funds

Program Overview – Expenses

Transit Expenses - \$5,623,238



DEPT STAFF

- 17 full time drivers
- 3 part time drivers
- 4 full time dispatchers
- 1 Operations Manager
- 1 Program Manager

Maintenance provided by Josephine County Fleet

- 4 full time mechanics –
*not part of department budget

Budget Goal 1 – efficiency, transparency and public engagement

- Compliance with all federal and state laws
- Utilized funding in accordance with adopted plans
- Continued coordination and program recommendations from Special Transportation Advisory Committee



Budget Goal 2 – ensure long term financial stability of core services

- All projects for funding must be listed in approved STIF plan (payroll tax)
 - This also includes projects that are just matching of federal funds
- Capital projects are organized and planned in conjunction with local match availability
- Any proposed service improvements must be sustainable for 3 years minimum





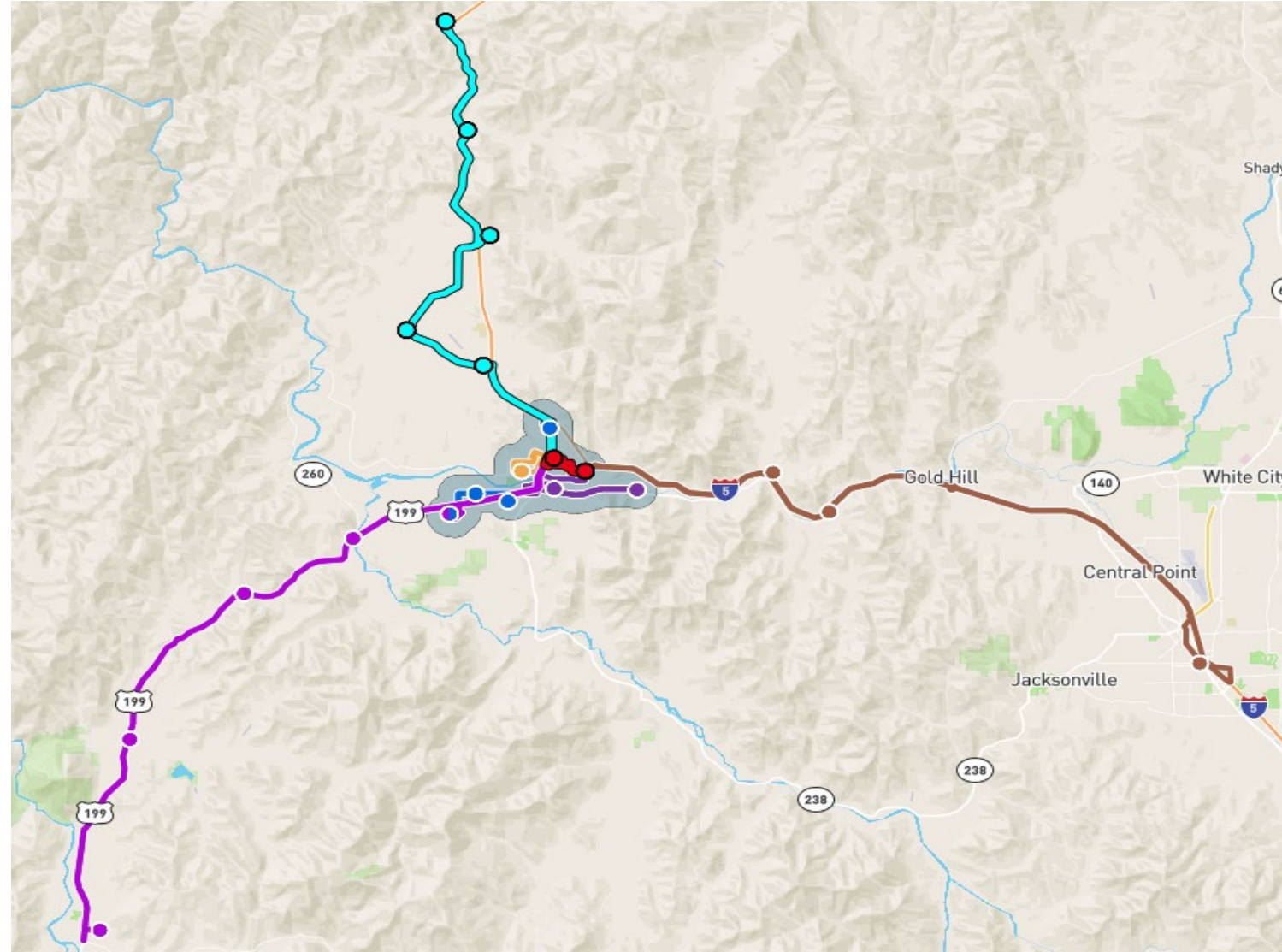
Budget Goal 3 – strategic investments in safety and community infrastructure

- Provide services to improve community mobility, regardless of individual transportation options
- Maintain federal standards for capital replacement and maintenance requirements
- Strive to match FTA Small Transit Intensive Cities measurement criteria
- Continue improving passenger safety and system usability through technological implementation



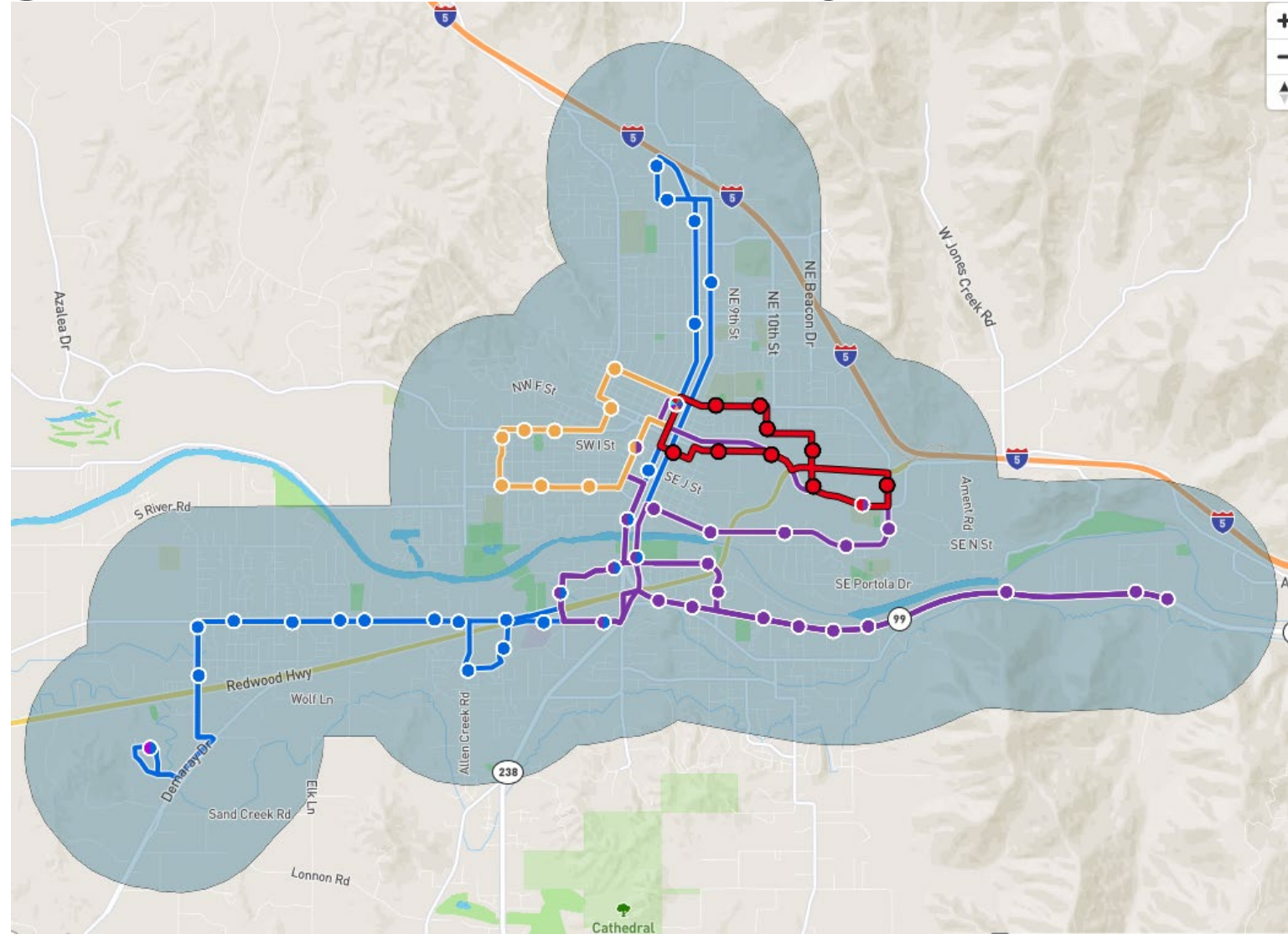
Transit Program – Five Year Goals

- Increase all routes to 20-30 service frequency – UGB focus
- Saturday Service
- West/East Grants Pass
- Expand service south along Hwy 238, north up I-5
- Continued service innovation and adoption of efficient technology
- Continued progress in fuel diversity of revenue fleet



Transit Program – Service Summary

- Fixed routes, commuter routes, paratransit service and demand response service
- Monday through Friday 5:30am to 6:30pm
- Grid pattern route design for directional transfers
- One of five small urban transit systems in Oregon
 - **RIDERSHIP**
- Provides around 135,000 rides annually on the fixed routes (56 passengers per hour system wide)
- Provides around 13,000 ADA paratransit trips (1.9 passengers per hour)



Department of Recreation

Prepared by: Tamra Martin

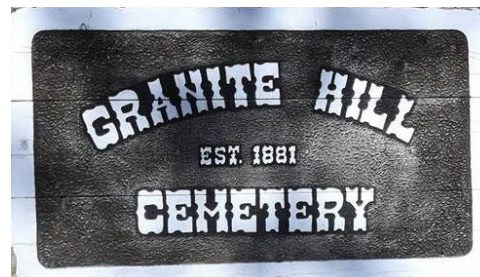


PURPOSE:

Fairgrounds: to provide the citizens of Josephine County a high functioning multi-use facility year-round filled with opportunities for education, agriculture, social engagement, entertainment and economic growth while being a resource for emergency response support and enhancing tourism, all the while honoring our County's traditions.

Granite Hill Cemetery: to honor and preserve the cemetery's rich historic legacy while managing it's 40 acres. Ensuring accurate records, public access, safety, maintenance and community service for future generations.

Parks: provide safe, accessible and well-maintained public lands that support recreation, economic development through tourism, environmental stewardship and quality of life for our community.





BUDGET GOAL #1: Improve Efficiency, Transparency and Public Engagement

Efficiency Initiative:

- The department will continue to maintain and further develop strong volunteer programs, including:
 - Park and Campground Hosts and Caretakers
 - Park Patrol and Safety Volunteers
 - Community Clean Up Days
 - County Fair Superintendents
 - County Fair Volunteers
 - Community Partnerships with local Service Groups
- The Fair Board works year-round and has a volunteer committee that is focused on:
 - Preventive maintenance planning
 - Facility preparation and long-term upkeep
- These combined efforts have allowed the department to:
 - Operate effectively with reduced staffing levels
 - Decrease costly emergency repairs and expenses
 - Increase operational expertise and program support across all department functions



BUDGET GOAL #1: Improve Efficiency, Transparency and Public Engagement

Enhanced Services Initiative:

- **Increase the number of community-use days and events across all properties including:**
 - Family Community Events including seasonal and holiday activities for community
 - Tourism-focused Events that bring positive impact to our local economy
- **Strengthen community communication and outreach through:**
 - Reestablishing the Josephine County Parks Advisory Committee
 - Partnerships with local organizations and stakeholders
 - Public Releases & Social Media engagement

Success Measures:

- Increased facility and park usage
- Higher event attendance numbers
- Growth in online reservations

Overall yields an increase in public engagement and community participation

BUDGET GOAL #2: Ensure Long-Term Financial Sustainability of Core Services

Strategic Planning:

Develop and maintain a multi-year strategic financial plan to support the long-term sustainability for each program: Fairgrounds, Parks and Granite Hill Cemetery

- Reduce reliance on one-time or unpredictable revenue sources
- Prioritize diversified and sustainable funding sources
 - Facility users, events, sponsorships, partnerships and grant opportunities
- Balance infrastructure, public access, and community programming
 - Land and facility management

Success Measures:

Conduct an annual review of programs, events and facilities ensuring the alignment of expenditures to strategic planning focusing on:

- High-use facilities and assets
- Essential maintenance needs
- Programs that provide measurable public benefit

BUDGET GOAL #3: Strategic Investment in Public Safety and Community Infrastructure

- Maintain and invest in all properties to support:
 - Emergency readiness and access
 - Public health and safety
 - Year-round community use
- Maintain coordinated planning with public safety partners, including:
 - Josephine County Sheriff's Office
 - Josephine County Emergency Management
 - Local public safety agencies
- Ensure Fairgrounds and park facilities can effectively and safely support:
 - Large-scale community events
 - Emergency response operations
 - Public safety needs

BUDGET GOAL #3: Strategic Investment in Public Safety and Community Infrastructure

Infrastructure & Capital Improvement Priorities

- Prioritize capital improvements and infrastructure upgrades that enhance:
 - Safety, Reliability, Accessibility
- Invest in improvements such as:
 - Lighting upgrades
 - ADA accessibility improvements
 - Facility modernization and infrastructure reliability
- Utilize long-term financial strategies to guide:
 - Preventative maintenance
 - Asset replacement planning
 - Modernization projects
- Evaluate fiscally responsible funding options for major projects, including:
 - Grants
 - Partnerships
 - Bond financing, when appropriate

Support community well-being, resilience, and public access to recreation facilities



Questions?

Thank you!